

myBCteam

New social network site has been launched for the women who have faced breast cancer and to connect with others who are going through the same. <http://www.mybcteam.com/>

**Sony Xperia Miro**

Sony launched its new flagship in India at ₹15,249 featuring 800MHz processor with 512MB of RAM

HP Envy 4-1002TX ultrabook

The best ultrabook money can buy under ₹60,000



With a lot of premium aluminum used on its chassis, the HP Envy looks and feels more expensive than it actually is. Brushed metal finish on its screen lid is carried forward to the area surrounding the keypad as well. While the finish is matte, it has a surprising habit of accumulating smudges. The soft finish on the bottom in the crimson red colour does make the ultrabook stand out in. Generous cooling vents along its side help keep the heat at bay, in case you are using this placed on the lap for extended durations.

The Series 5's display is slightly brighter than the Envy's, but the latter is very comfortable to use for longer periods. Colour reproduction is on the softer side, making the HP ultrabook's screen less harsh on the eyes, particularly with the bright colours. We compared this to the Samsung Series 5 and the Toshiba Satellite U840 side-by-side, and the HP's display was better and easier on the eyes. However, the reflective nature does spoil the experience somewhat, and you would have to push

the brightness up a notch to compensate in a typical office or outdoor environment.

The island keyboard is extremely comfortable to get used to, with a well-spaced layout and adequate travel. The left and right click keys are integrated on the touchpad, but actual key area is a little too close to the bottom left and bottom right edge. The Envy has the Beats Audio speaker hardware and software, and the requisite branding. However, just like with the phones, there isn't much of a difference to the audio quality as against the Altec Lansing that HP uses on the Pavilion G-series. We would not recommend that the Beats Audio thing be your sole criteria while deciding on buying this ultrabook.

Speaking of pre-installed stuff, HP has streamlined its own utilities, features of which can now be accessed via the larger Support Assistant software. There's fewer trial/demo software pre-loaded – something that helps the Envy cut down on mindless bloatware.

On the spec sheet, the Samsung Series 5 has a faster Core i5 – 3210M clocking at 2.5 GHz, and 6 GB of RAM. However, in our benchmark tests, the HP Envy is consistently ahead of the Samsung ultrabook, making it the fastest ultrabook under ₹60,000. The PC Mark Vantage score of 9966 on the Envy is higher than the 7,465 the Series 5 scored. In PC Mark 7, the Envy scored 3150, while the Series 5 had to make do with 2371. The HP Envy's AMD Radeon HD 7670M (2 GB) graphics do well when compared to the NVIDIA

GeForce GT620M graphics on the Series 5. The 3D Mark 11 (all three levels) and Unigine Heaven benchmark scores were consistently higher than all the rivals we pitted against it.

Most surprisingly, the battery life offered by the Envy 4-1002tx is very good. In our battery benchmark tests, this one lasted 223 minutes from full charge to full discharge. As a result, the battery life is superb in a real-life usage scenario. With no music playing in the background, we put this through our daily grind – web browsing, mails, typing articles, working on Excel and a bit of YouTube sessions – the Envy lasted 7.5 hours from full charge to full discharge. Among the software and utilities preloaded by HP, CoolSense technology deserves the most mention. It's a configurable feature which allows you to keep the machine cool by clocking down the processor cores individually, depending on load, and this does make a considerable difference in the heat it generates.

Among all the other contenders, should you buy the HP Envy 4 ultrabook? If you have a budget of ₹60,000, the HP Envy has the best package – good performance and build. The Samsung Series 5 is a fairly consistent performer and offers an optical drive as well, but the HP steals the march with much better looks and a slightly slimmer form factor. And the HP Envy has a clear advantage in gaming, with the Radeon HD 7670M consistently scoring more than the Series 5's. This is a very good product.

Vishal Matbur

Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i5 - 3317U @ 1.7GHz; **RAM:** 4GB;

Display: 14-inch (1366 x 768 pixels); **Graphics:** AMD Radeon HD 7670M / Intel HD 4000; **Storage:** 500GB with 32GB flash; **Ports:** Two USB 3.0, One USB 2.0, HDMI out;

OS: Windows 7 Home Basic

Contact

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Price: ₹58,325

7.5
/ 10

Features	7.0
Performance.....	8.0
Build Quality	7.0
Value for Money	7.5